



HARVESTING AND STORING

Ripe medlars will lift easily from the tree in mid-fall. Dip the stems in a concentrated salt solution to preserve them, and then leave for several weeks in a cool, dark place, with “eyes” facing downward to decompose, or “blet.” They will then be ready to eat—“bletting” gives the flesh an almost sickly sweet flavor.

Quinces can be harvested when fruits are golden-yellow in color, and, provided conditions are frost-free, they improve the longer they are left on the tree. Store in a cool, dark place, leaving space between the fruits.

PESTS AND DISEASES

Quinces are sometimes affected by diseases such as leaf blight and brown rot. Water regularly to prevent fruits from splitting. To discourage disease, prune in winter, and allow good airflow. Medlars are usually trouble-free.



Blight (right) discolors quince leaves.